Regulations for the Garden of Remembrance and Ashes Plots

in the Parish of Mickleham

1. **Rights of Interment**
   1.1. A parishioner has a right to the burial of his/her cremated remains ('ashes') in a churchyard and the cremated remains of non-parishioners can also be buried there if there is a connection to the parish and the Incumbent consents.
   1.2. Applications for the interment of ashes must be made to the Incumbent, who will decide the place of interment.
   1.3. The names of those whose ashes are interred, together with a record of where they are interred, will be recorded in the Burial Register to be kept in the Church safe.
   1.4. A memorial 'Book of Remembrance' is kept in the Church in which entries may be made, subject to the approval of the Incumbent, by a calligrapher approved by the Incumbent.
2. **Garden of Remembrance**
   2.1. Cremated remains may be interred in a family grave but otherwise will be buried in the Garden of Remembrance.
   2.2. A maximum of 2 family members may be interred in each plot.
   2.3. The ashes should normally be buried without their container. (At the discretion of the Incumbent, such remains may be buried in a casket or urn, provided it is made of a biodegradable material).
3. **Garden of Remembrance Memorials**
   3.1. The Garden of Remembrance is designed as a tranquil space. Faculty has been granted that a bronze plaque available from the Church, measuring 5" x 3" including the deceased's name and dates, may be placed on the plot.
   3.2. Each plot should be kept free of additional decorations that may encroach on a neighbouring plot. Loose laid flowers are preferred but a maximum of one plant or small vase of flowers in a non-plastic container is permitted. Flowers or pots should not be wrapped in cellophane. Flowers and plants must be removed when withered. Vases which are no longer in use must be removed. Artificial flowers are discouraged and will be removed after 2 months. Figures, characters, toys and other memorabilia should not be placed permanently on or around a plot. They must be removed within 12 months of the date of interment. If such items are not removed in good time, then the Incumbents or churchwardens may do so.
4. **Ashes Plots in Churchyard Extension**
   4.1. Cremated remains may be interred in a family grave but otherwise may be buried in an area set aside in the churchyard extension.
   4.2. A maximum of 4 family members may be interred in each plot.
   4.3. The ashes should normally be buried without their container. (At the discretion of the Incumbent, such remains may be buried in a casket or urn, provided that it is made of a biodegradable material).
5. **Ashes Plots in the Churchyard Extension Memorials**
   5.1. Faculty has been granted that a small upright headstone may be placed on the plot. A period of 6 months after the date of interment should be allowed for ground settlement before the headstone is placed.
   5.2. Headstone design:
      a. Memorials must be of weathering natural stone or light grey marble. The stone (including the lettering surface) shall not be finished with a polished or reflecting surface.
      b. A memorial must not include any lighting, video or sound recording, any glass or moulding, any portrait, photograph or other image of an individual, any QR code or other machine-readable label, any kerbs or other fencing, railings or other demarcation or any stone or glass chippings.

c. A memorial should measure 55cm W x 45cm H x 7.5cm D (these are the maximum above ground dimensions) and be either rectangular or slightly rounded on top with black incised writing.
d. The Christian and surnames of the deceased should be given, with the dates of birth and death (or age and date of death). Nicknames may only be used where appropriate and if agreed with the Incumbent.
e. Biblical and other literary inscriptions compatible with the Christian faith are permitted, but any epitaph must be agreed with the Incumbent.
f. Any inscription must be accurate, should honour the dead, comfort the living and inform posterity.
g. No advertisement or trademark shall be inscribed on any memorial, but the name of the mason may be inscribed low down on the side or reverse of the stone in unpainted and unleaded letters no larger than 13mm (1/2") in height.
h. Any etching or carving must not depict any individual or cover more than one fifth of the surface of the memorial.
i. All memorials must be securely fixed in the ground supported by a pre-cast concrete shoe situated below the ground.

5.3. Permission must be sought from the Incumbent on form CR1 available from the church website, micklehamchurch.org.uk (found in Worship then Regulations), or from the Incumbent. **Written permission is <u>always</u> required**, and no work should be ordered or put in hand until permission has been granted in writing by the Incumbent.

5.4. Each plot should be kept free of additional decorations that may encroach on a neighbouring plot. Loose laid flowers preferred but each plot may have a maximum of one plant or small vase of flowers in a non-plastic container. Flowers or pots should not be wrapped in cellophane. Flowers must be removed when withered. Vases which are no longer in use must be removed. Artificial flowers are discouraged and will be removed after 2 months. Figures, characters, toys and other memorabilia should not be placed permanently on or around a plot. They must be removed within 12 months of the date of interment. If such items are not removed in good time, then Incumbents or churchwardens may do so.

6. Fees

6.1. The fees for the interment of ashes and for memorials are contained in the current Parochial Fees Order and St Michael's Church Fees List. Those for inscriptions in the Book of Remembrance shall be fixed by the PCC.

7. Ecochurch

St Michael's is an Ecochurch. We respectfully ask for cooperation and consideration in keeping the churchyard as natural as possible, avoiding plastics and aiming for greater sustainability.